GLC



Thamesmead



The First Areas

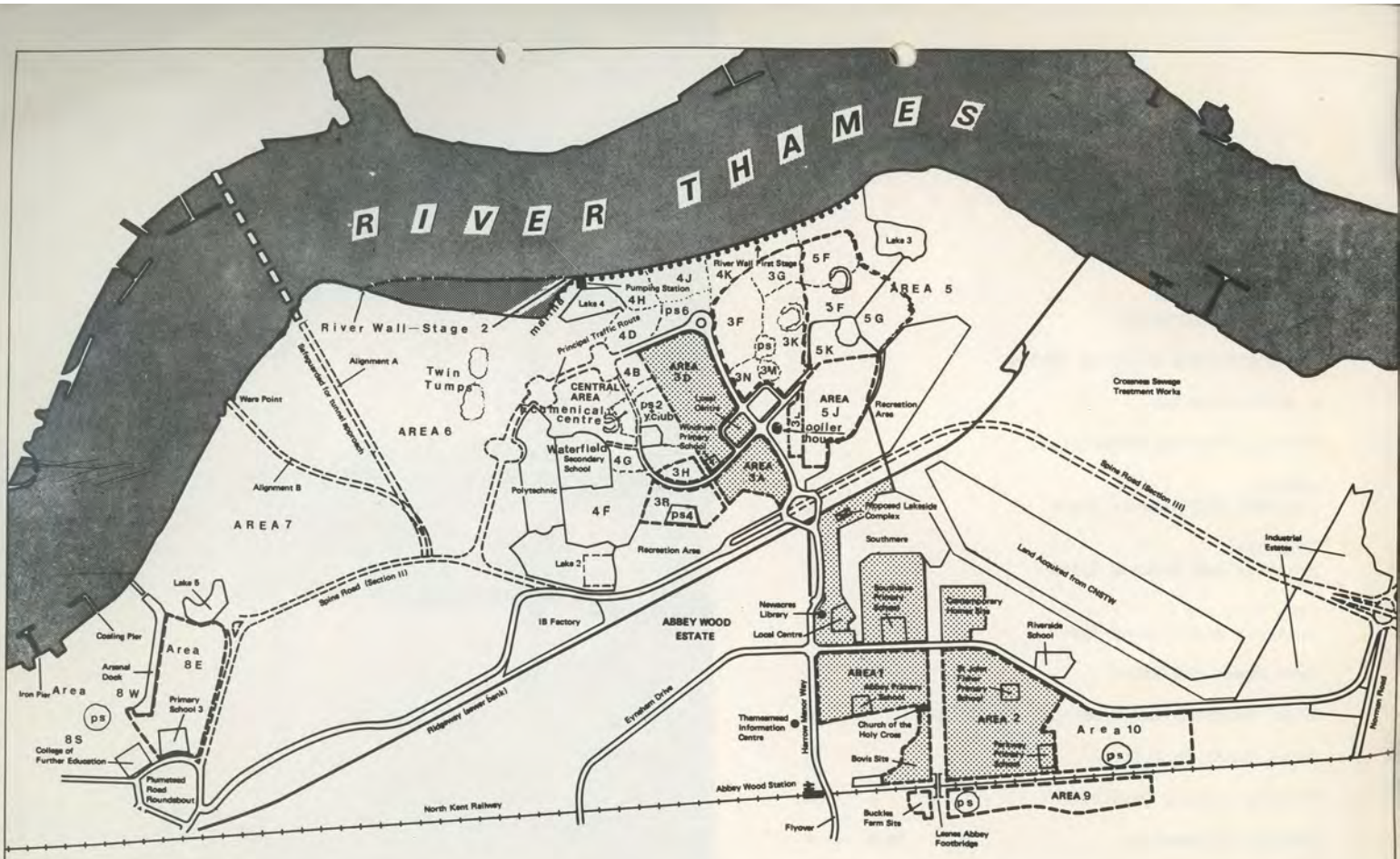


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Construction of point blocks flanking Southmere Lake in Area I





THAMESMEAD

March 1976

This brochure describes the work in the first contract which involves the construction of 4159 dwellings with associated buildings and civil engineering work in Areas I, II, IIIA and IIID of Thamesmead. The contract was let to Holland Hannen and Cubitts (Southern) Ltd. in late 1966 and work on these areas started early in 1967.

LOCATION

Areas I and II (Newacres) are in the south east sector of Thamesmead and are bounded:

a) on the south by the North Kent railway line, areas of inter-war housing and the wooded hills of Bostall Heath and Abbey Wood;
b) on the west by Harrow Manor Way (now one of the principal traffic routes) and the post war Abbey Wood housing estate;
c) on the north by the six metre high Ridgeway and
d) on the east by substantial tree belts, areas of recreational open space and a 14.2 hectare (35 acre) secondary school screening the housing from the industrial areas beyond.

Areas IIIA and IIID are located north of Area I and extend from the Ridgeway to within 500 metres of the river. These are the first sites to be developed on that part of the Thamesmead development area which was formerly part of the Woolwich Arsenal, and they now form an important link with Areas I and II and the future central area.

SITE CONDITIONS

In common with much of the Thamesmead development area, these sites are flat, low lying marshland with a high ground water table. The land is generally well below high tide level. The nature of the sub soil, which is alluvial with an upper stratum of peat some 5 to 7 metres deep, overlying a loadbearing stratum of gravel, which necessitates the use of piled foundations for all buildings and much of the civil engineering work.

Large areas of the sites south of the Ridgeway were covered with sand to an average depth of one metre to improve falls in the drainage networks. This filling also provided a solid base for movement of construction vehicles, plant and pile driving rigs.

The influence of pollution from industry on the north bank of the Thames has implications over the whole of the development area. Surveys carried out indicate that air pollution can reach objectionable levels at heights of between 40 and 60 metres depending upon the distance from source and the direction and velocity of the wind. Height of development has therefore been limited in accordance with this advice.

THE VALUE COST CONTRACT

By 1966 the designs for the first stages of the Thamesmead housing development were well advanced. To get building underway as quickly as possible it was decided that the construction of dwellings and associated civil engineering work in Areas I, II and III should be carried out under a Value Cost contract.

Accordingly in December 1966 a Value Cost contract was signed with Holland Hannen and Cubitts (Southern) Ltd. for 4000 dwellings. The scope of this contract has since been increased a number of times, to include the layout of the Eastern Industrial Estate and construction of twelve unit factories, river defence works, Bexley's Medical Centre and a number of other small works for both Bexley and the GLC.

Under a Value Cost form of contract the Council finances the whole of the work and a special Estate Account is set up from which payment is made of all expenditure properly incurred by the Contractor during the progress of the work

ie. payment of wages, materials, plant, fuel, offices etc.

It is an incentive form of Contract and the Contractor is paid a fee for managing the Contract and the amount of fee is determined by the comparison of "Value" to "Actual Cost". The Bills of Quantities contain tendered "Values of the work" and the value of the work is calculated from these Bills and compared with the "Actual cost of the work". If the "Value" and "Cost" correspond, the Contractor receives a normal fee; if "Value" is above the "Cost" he receives a bonus addition to normal fee; and if below, the normal fee is reduced. In certain conditions he may have to reimburse the Council certain costs.

The Council employs staff on site to monitor the Contractor's permformance and progress including staff from the GLC Treasurer's Department who are responsible for the strict control of expenditure.

Under the "Value Cost" form of contract, work can be commenced more quickly than with more traditional methods of contracting because it is not necessary to have completely detailed layouts, and working drawings or bills of quantities available before tendering or negotiation and work can be started as soon as adequate working drawings have been prepared for the first section of the development. Within the framework of the contract variations and modifications can be easily introduced as well as Industrialised and System Building techniques. Its flexibility enables all ancillary works to be built including those related to full community facilities.

INDUSTRIALISED BUILDING SYSTEM

The successful tenderer for this first contract, namely Holland Hannen and Cubitts (Southern) Ltd., is the sole agent in this country for the French Balency and Briard system and the tender was based on the use of that system.

The decision to adopt industrialised building techniques at Thamesmead was based inter alia on the size of the project, the programme for its construction, the availability of resources of materials and manpower, and encouragement by the Government to local authorities at the time to adopt this form of building.

It was anticipated that traditional methods of construction would not be adequate to ensure the pace of development required by the programme and also that the necessary labour force would be extremely difficult to recruit and to maintain, particularly during periods of maximum activity in the building industry, such as applied in the mid 1960's when the decision was taken.

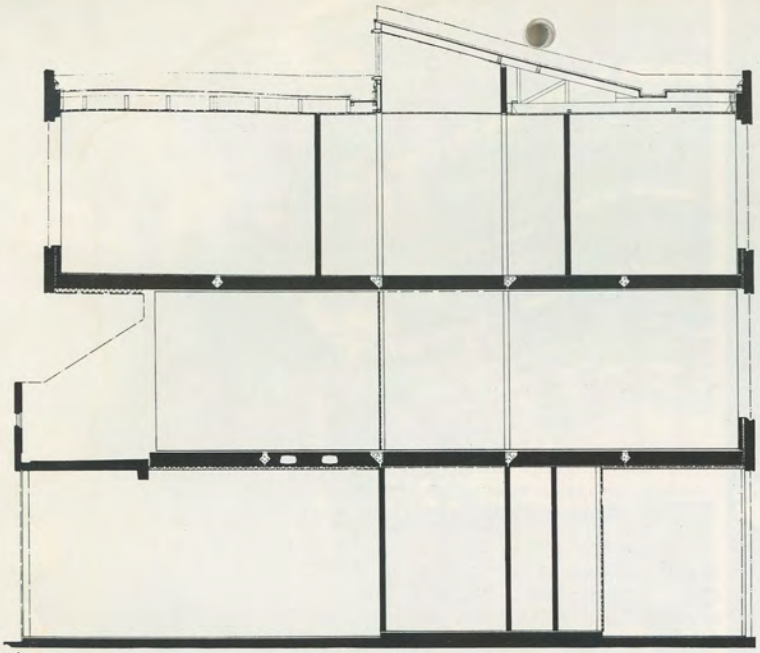
The Contractor's experience in the use of a concrete system whether his own or that of another manufacturer, which he used under licence was one of the principal factors taken into account in the selection of tenderers.

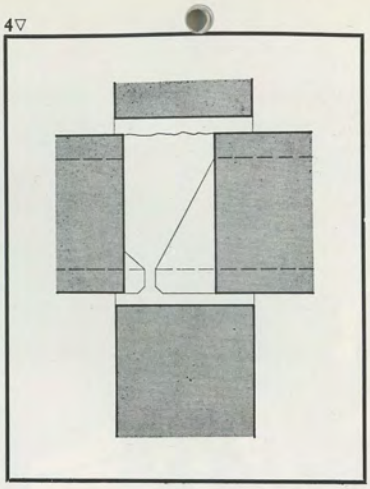
The factory for the production of concrete components of the system was designed by the GLC Architects Department and constructed by Cubitts in consultation with Balency on the Thamesmead site in 1967. The building was opened in January 1968 and was in full production by July 1968.

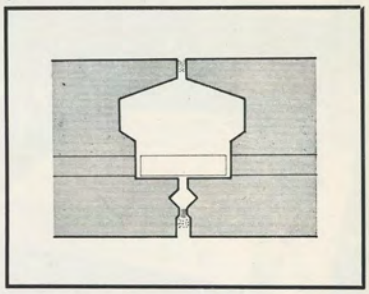
The main production halls covered an area of 7432 square metres (86000 square feet) in addition to ancillary areas of office, canteen, maintenance and storage accommodation. There was a stockyard adjacent to the building where completed components were stored prior to transportation to the building sites. This yard included a 'cold cast area where panels for the linear block and canal units were manufactured.

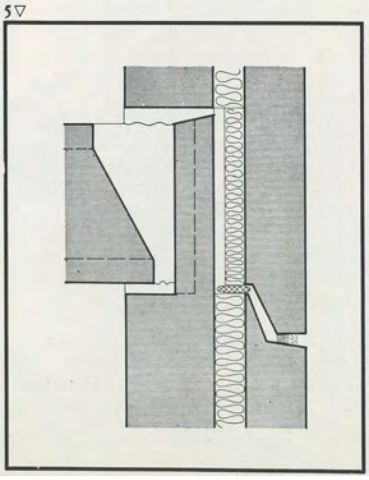
Other components were cast in steel moulds in three different types: Horizontal table moulds for external walls; vertical moulds for internal walls and special moulds for stairs, balcony fronts and other units of a special nature.

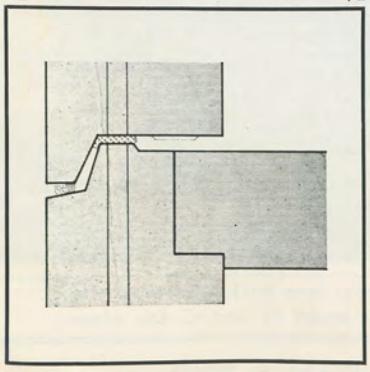
External wall panels are cast flat with the external face downwards. The base plate is coated with a cement retarder and the panel is built up in the following order of layers:

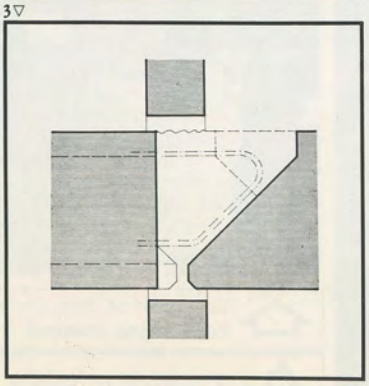






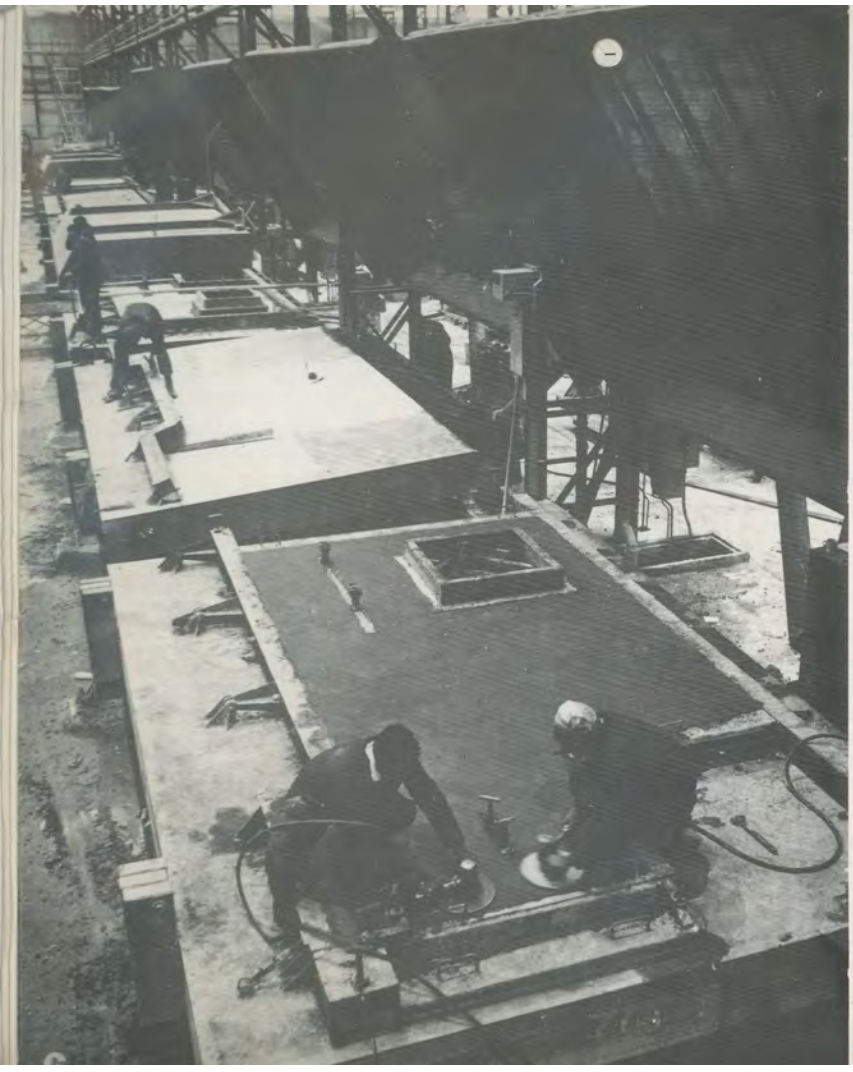






1 *Section through 5-person 3-storey house.*
2 *Horizontal joint between external wall panels.*
3 *Connection between floor slabs.*
4 *Junction of floor slabs at cross wall positions.*
5 *Junction for floor slab and external wall.*
6 *Vertical joint between external wall panels.*

Reprinted from
"Architectural Design" November 1969





Interior of the Industrialised Building Factory - Unit being removed from mould by travelling crane

Finishing of panels in horizontal moulds

a 75mm outer skin faced in Arclyt Norwegian spar; a 125mm inner load bearing skin; 25mm polystyrene insulation and a 125mm loadbearing inner skin. The two load bearing layers are tied together with stainless steel ties fixed to the reinforcement in each skin.

Concrete for internal walls is injected pneumatically from the underside of the vertical moulds to give greater control over the placing, to avoid distortion of the steel and segregation of the mix and to allow for the natural displacement of air.

The concrete mix is preheated to about 34°C, and the moulds to about 45°C, the period of initial curing being five hours for floor units, four hours for external walls and three hours for internal walls. After this, the units may be transported for stacking to begin the normal 28 day curing period, and it is at this juncture that the retarded laitence on external walls is hosed and brushed off and the Arclyt spar aggregate exposed. All internal faces come from the moulds ready to recieve decoration, either paper or paint.

The Balency system differs from most heavy systems in that that floors are cast in situ, the pre-cast elements being reserved for walls only. This principle was modified for Thamesmead in that the floors for the 3 storey houses - generally in long terraces - were pre-cast (approximately two units per room) for the more efficient use of cranes.

Fixing blocks, electrical conduit, junction and outlet boxes are cast into wall units, and line up with preformed electrical wiring harnesses which are cast, with the necessary reinforcement cages, into the insitu floors or into the perimeter stitching concrete where pre-cast floors are used. Other services, hot and cold water supply and soil pipes, are cast into special wall units known as 'technical blocks' which can be formed to almost any shape required by the plan subject to limitations of structural feasibility and weight.

Erection demands a level bed to a tolerance of +-10mm, panels being levelled by aluminium wedges, and plumbed with adjustable inclined props secured to screw inserts in floors and panels. The bed joint is normally 19mm and vertical joints between units 12mm. Bedding and jointing mortar is used fairly dry, and is packed with pneumatic rammers. Pointing is done when joints, either dry pack or stitching concrete, has reached its required strength. Rigid jointing is provided at the tops of panels, by casting protruding reinforcement from the wall units into the floors. In the case of pre-cast floors, this reinforcement is secured to the stitching reinforcement in the horizontal joints.

Joints in external walls are 'closed', in that a poly-sulphide mastic and plastic foam caulking is used at the face of the joint as the first line of defence. Behind this, a decompression void is formed by the profile of the side of each panel and this in turn is protected against the ingress of stitching concrete in the inner skin zone by a waterproofed insulating membrane situated level with the insulation within the panel. This membrane not only serves to ensure 'openess' of the decompression/ drainage void, but prevents the formation of a cold bridge through the external wall.

DISTRICT HEATING

During the early design period for Area I and II it was decided that a district heating system would be used for the GLC controlled housing areas, schools and some other ancillary buildings.

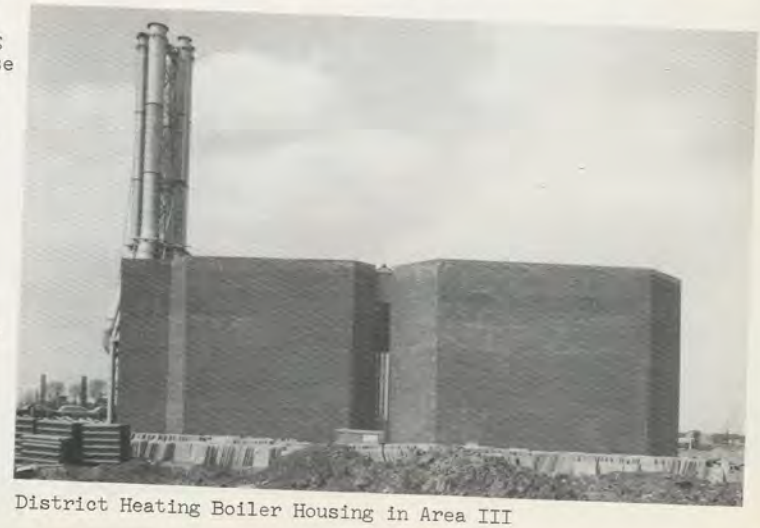
A heavy concrete industrialised building system results in cold surfaces and is more likely to cause condensation problems than traditional building methods. District heating was therefore chosen in an attempt to reduce condensation. This form of heating, with full 'landlord' control and charged at a standard weekly rate, does not induce a resident to turn his heating off. Consequently an effective heat level is maintained in each dwelling at all times. It also keeps the cost to the resident as low as possible.

A temporary boiler house was built in 1968 to serve Areas I and II. It was situated to the north of Southmere lake and served 2741 dwellings, four schools and ancillary buildings in these two areas and had provision for serving some dwellings in Area III until the permanent boiler house was completed. The permanent boiler house to serve Areas I, II and III and their associated primary and secondary schools with hot water and heating was put into operation at the beginning of the winter of 1974. It is situated to the east of the Local Centre in Area III, has six boilers fired by natural gas, and has now completely replaced the temporary boiler house which has now been demolished.

Most of the district heating mains in Areas I and II are above ground, under balconies, walkways, bridges and through garages at first floor, soffit level. Where there is no route between blocks a buried pipe system is used. Mains from the boiler house connect to control points where facilities for balancing, draining down, straining and venting are situated. Up to fifty dwellings are served from one control point. Hot water is carried from the control points to each dwelling by a sub-mains distribution network. These sub-mains use a 'within structure' route where possible, or alternatively a ground duct has been placed alongside a block with a branch into each dwelling.

The mains system in Area III is contained within the linear blocks and is similar to that in Areas I and II. The layout of sub-mains is also similar for the industrialised linear housing but has had to be varied for the traditionally constructed housing as there are no first floor pedestrian links between these buildings and consequently no 'ready made' sub-mains routes. The low rise housing is supplied by ground ducts similar to Areas I and II.

The need for ground ducting in all areas meant considerable co-ordination of all the underground drainage, statutory services, foundations and landscaping.



District Heating Boiler Housing in Area III

GENERAL PLANNING PRINCIPLES AND DESIGN

The layouts of Areas I, II, IIIA and IIID reflect the general principles embodied in the Thamesmead Master Plan.

Development against major roads is linear in form, building up density towards the future Central Area and forming a protective wind and noise barrier between those roads and the low rise housing areas. The linear block running along Harrow Manor Way though no different in terms of population density from other parts of the site, forms a visual beginning of the system of high density high rise spines envisaged in the Master Plan. The green spaces, lakes and canals which form the basis of the land drainage system of Thamesmead have been incorporated in the design of housing areas in such a way as to maximise their environmental and recreational potential.

A cycle track network has been planned to connect housing areas with schools, employment and recreational areas. Pedestrian movement both within and between areas has been segregated from vehicular traffic movement.

Areas I and II

The detailed design of Areas I and II was, to a large extent developed at the same time as the Master Plan and implements the Master Plan principles of pedestrian/ vehicular segregation. Pedestrian movement in these areas is by upper level routes, at first floor, with their system of pedestrian bridges, and following the major traffic routes. Low rise housing areas are based on a system of ground level pedestrian circulation, uninterrupted by vehicular traffic.

Vehicular access to these areas is by way of a series of cul-de-sacs. which terminate on the fringes of the low rise housing, under the linear blocks or at the point block garage areas.

A local bylaw in force when the scheme was being designed required that there should be no habitable rooms at ground level because of the risk of flooding. As a result the whole scheme was raised off the ground, the ground floor being used only for garages, tenants' stores, services and in the case of three storey houses, for access to dwellings. This requirement made the principle of upper level pedestrian circulation easier to implement.

The Client Department required the maximum number of families to be housed with gardens, and in both Areas well over a third of the dwellings are so provided being primarily four and five person houses with a small number for six persons. There are also some four and five person maisonettes at first and third floor levels of the linear block where the absence of a garden is to some extent compensated by a very generous balcony-terrace adjoining the living room. Three person flats designed for elderly people are accessible from the first floor pedestrian deck, and two blocks of one person and two person flats for old people are linked to the linear block and to its pedestrian deck. The aim being to integrate (as much as possible) the elderly people with the rest of the community.

The distribution of various sizes of dwellings in different types of blocks is (with only minor modifications) the same in both Areas I and II.

Areas IIIA and IIID

Originally it was intended that Areas IIIA and IIID would be built entirely in the Balency industrialised concrete panels and the layout was designed with this in mind.

The GLC Architects' design for the linear blocks has been developed in detail for Cubitts by their own consultants and continues to be built by industrialised methods but with some simplification of building form and layout. However as a result of a study of cost levels undertaken in 1970 it was found that low rise blocks (which form the

core of the development) should be built more economically by traditional means.

Vehicular access on Area III is by a series of culs-de-sac leading from a perimeter estate road on the eastern side of the linear blocks. A traffic free zone running east to west through each low rise housing area is thus created.

The Linear Housing block in Area I.
Elevation to Harrow Manorway

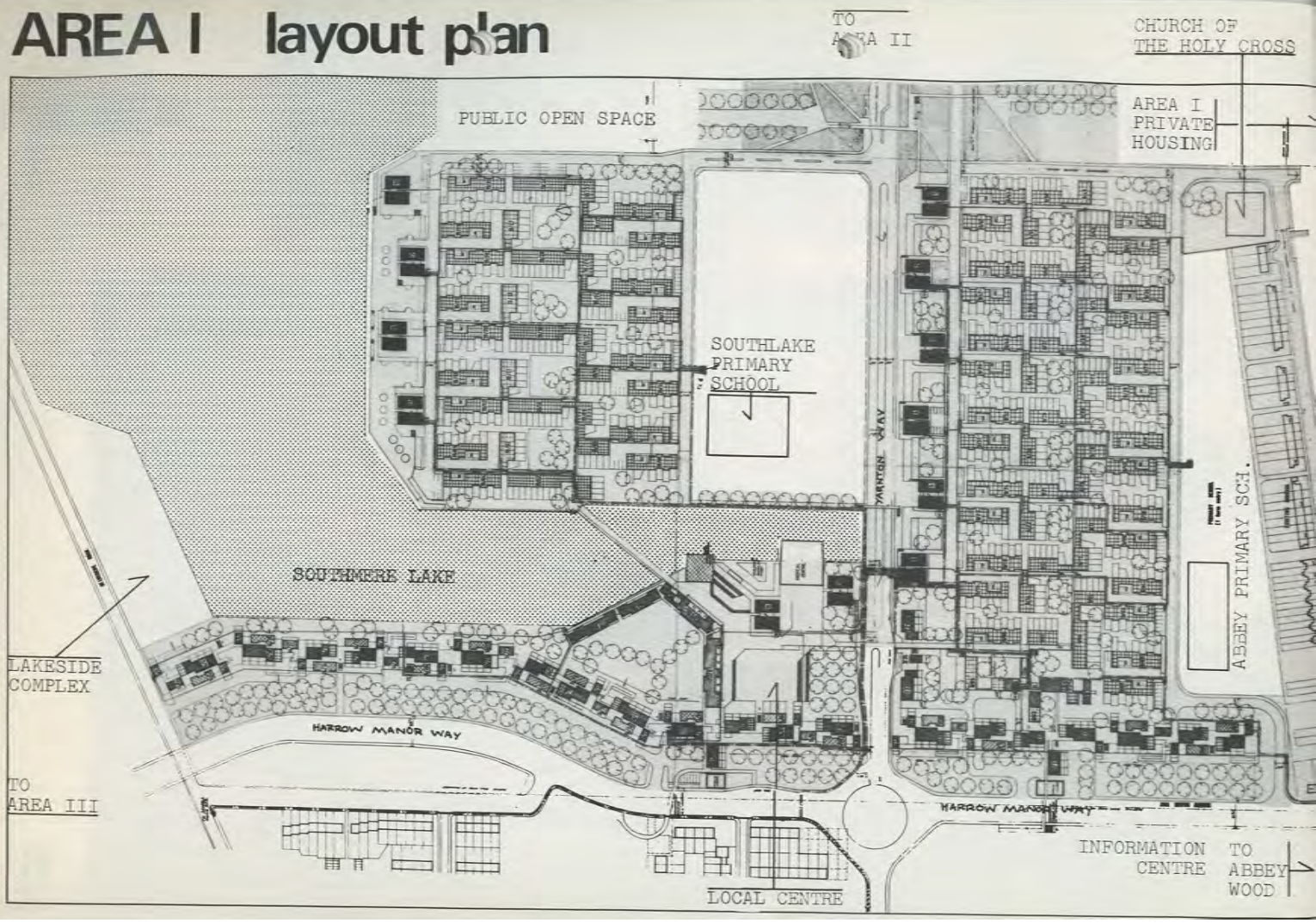
Point blocks and low rise housing flanking Hartslock Drive in Area I





AREA I

AREA I layout plan



ANALYSIS

Gross Area	33.6 hectares	(84 acres)
Housing Area		
GLC site	20 hectares	(50 acres)
Private	3.1 hectares	(7.8 acres)
Population		
GLC	5229 people in 1490 dwellings	
Private	479 people in 132 dwellings	
Density		
GLC	245 persons per hectare	(98 pp acre)
Private	119 persons per hectare	(53 pp acre)
Car Parking	1 space per dwelling	

Storeys	Persons/dwellings							Totals	
	OPD I	II	II	III	IV	V	VI	Dwell-ings	Per-sons
3					257	232	44	533	2452
2-5		34		8	157	101		300	1225
13			288	288				576	1440
3-4	50	31						81	112
	50	65	288	296	414	333	44	1490	5229

HOUSING TYPES

Point Blocks (13 storeys) Each block contains two 2 and two 3 person flats per floor, served by two lifts and a staircase. Of the twelve point blocks four are sited along the southern shore of the lake, two adjacent to the Local Centre and six along the southern side of Yarnton Way. These groups of point blocks are associated with pedestrian decks at first floor level constructed over extensive areas of garaging at ground level.

Linear Block (3-5 storey) This block, alomost one kilometre ($\frac{1}{2}$ mile) long, follows the line of Harrow Manor Way and defines the western boundary of Area I. It contains four and five person maisonettes together with a proportion of old peoples flats entered on alternating sides of the pedestrian walkways at first and third floor levels.

Unlike the other housing blocks in Areas I and II which are built with components from the industrialised building factory, this block is constructed by rationalised traditional methods. It has an insitu concrete and block structure, clad externally with panels of exposed aggregate concrete of almost identical composition to the IB units, but which are cold cast in timber moulds in a casting yard outside the factory.

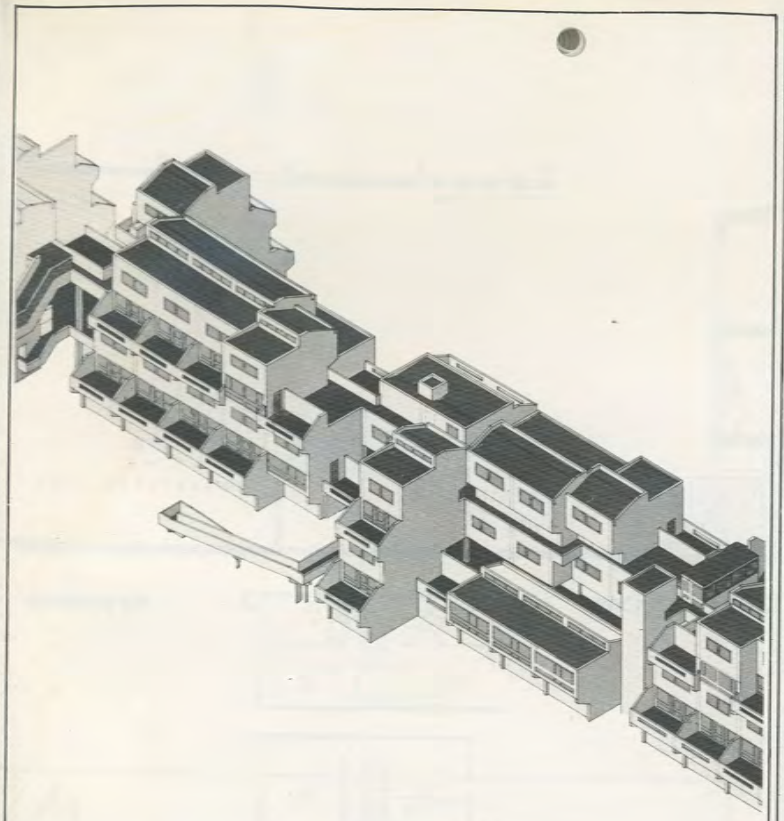
This method of construction was used partly because of the complex form of the building and partly because the programme for Area I, which required a start to be made on site well in advance of the completion of the IB factory.

Low Rise Housing (3 Storey) Four, five and six person terraced family houses, with gardens, and grouped around small landscaped courtyards, are planned in two zones; in the southern section of this Area, east of the linear block and in the northern section in association with the lake. Access to each house is either at ground floor level into an entrance lobby or at first floor level, off a walkway linking groups of blocks together.

Two garages are provided beneath each of the larger houses in the mews on the north and south sides of the low rise housing zones. One garage is directly accessible from the house and the second is for the use of the residents in one of the smaller houses located away from the roads in the centre of the zone.

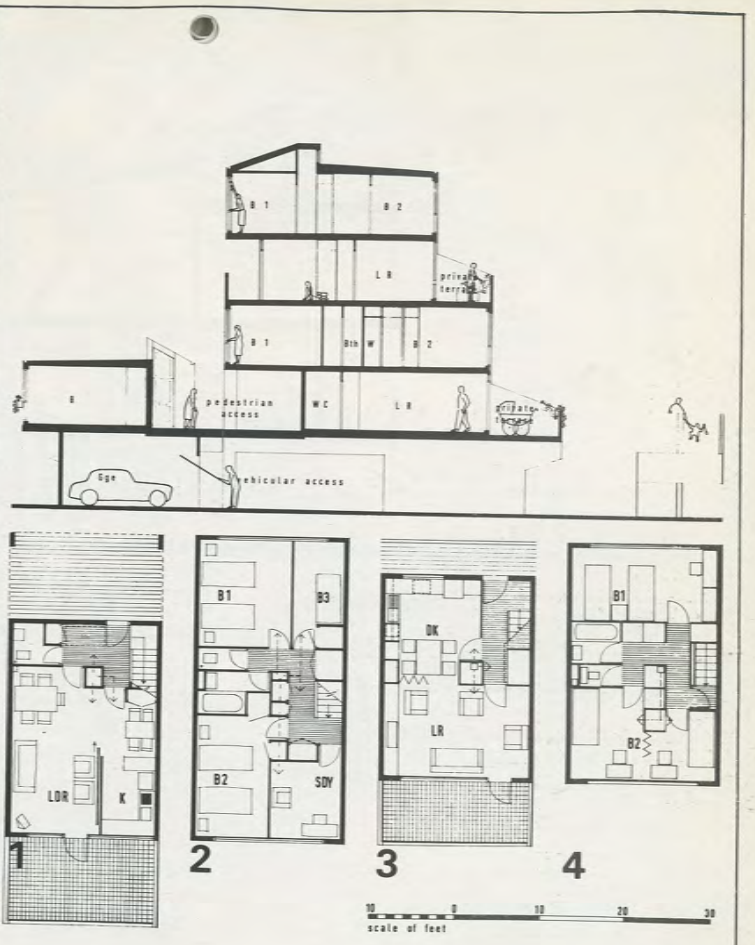
Old Peoples Dwellings Flats for old people (in addition to the accommodation in the linear block) are provided in two blocks. Each block is serviced by lifts and has a clubroom for the occupants exclusive use.

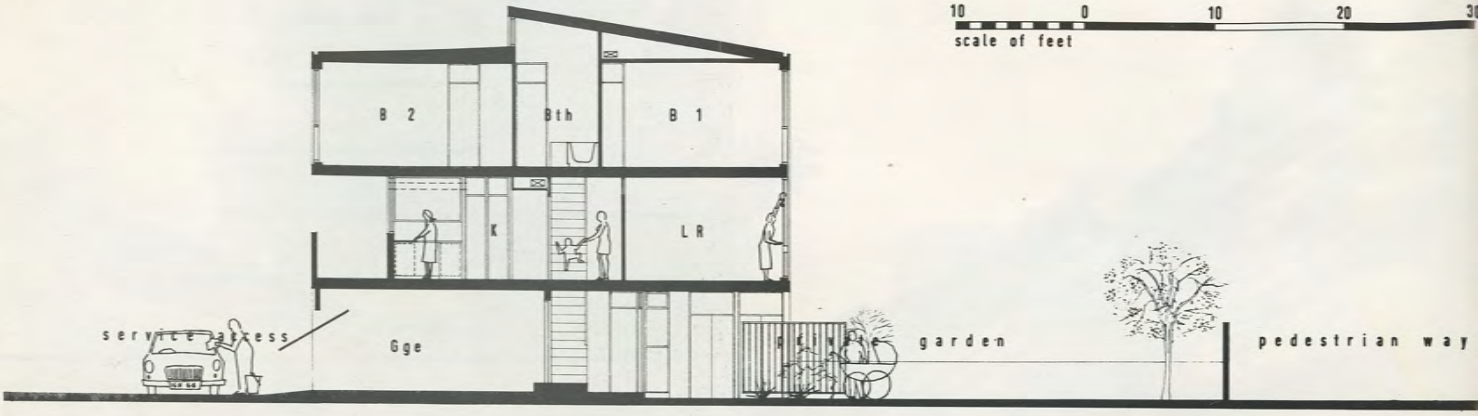


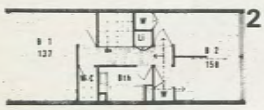


Low rise housing (left) by Southmere Lake with Area I local centre and point blocks in background.

Area I Linear Housing Block - Isometric drawing and typical sections and plans.

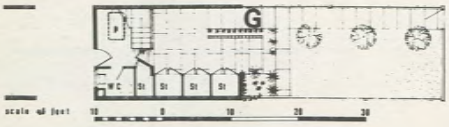


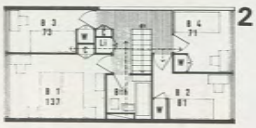




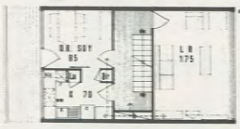
four persons

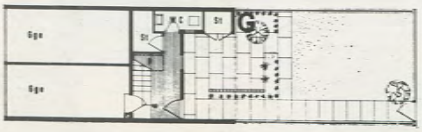


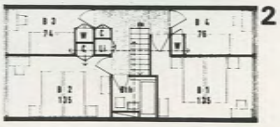




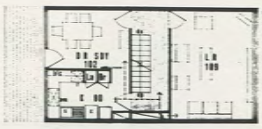
five persons







six persons





Low rise housing - section and plans for 4, 5 and 6-person housing in Areas I and II.

Low rise housing in the southern portion of Area I





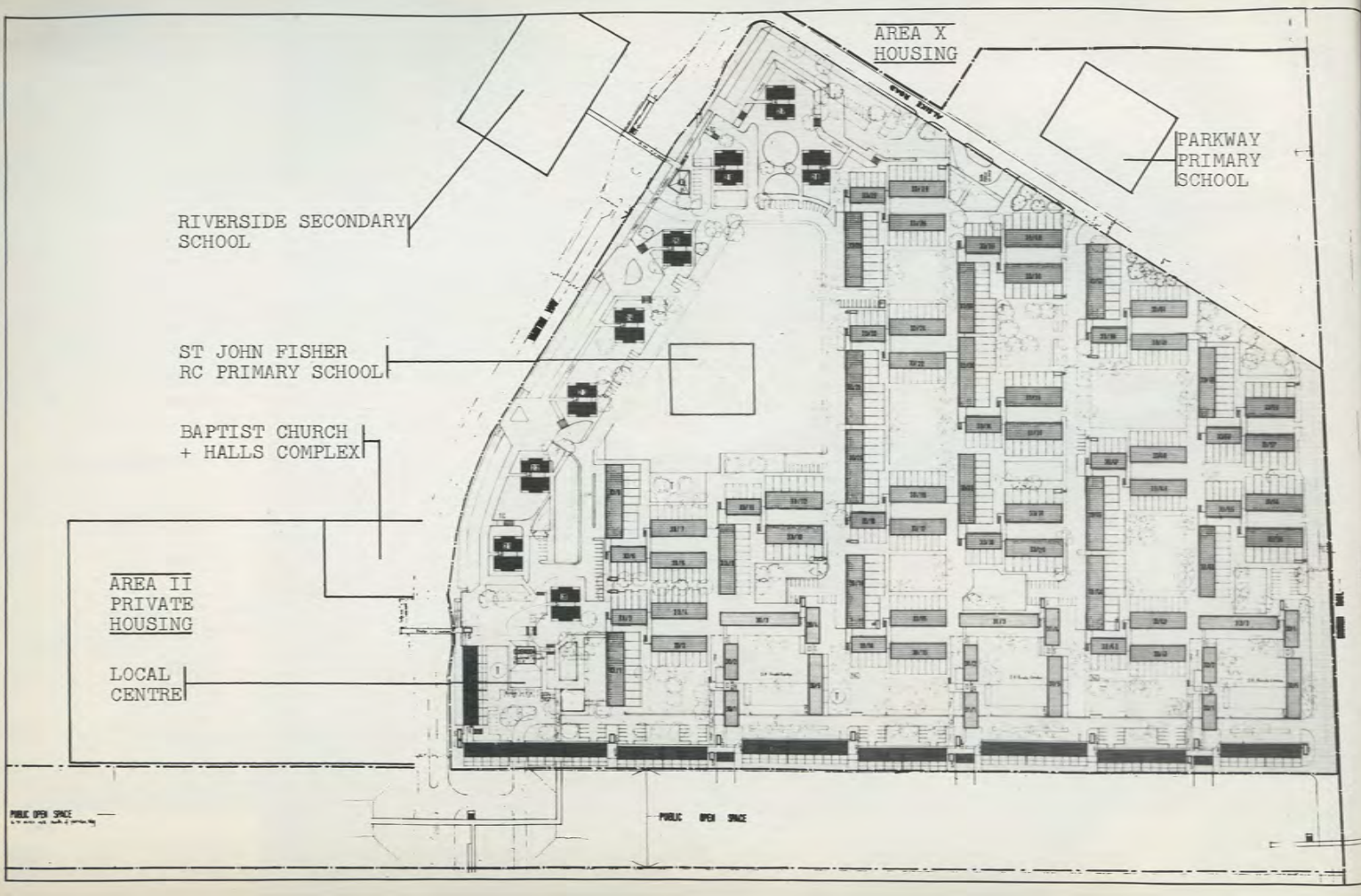
Area I linear housing block (background) with steps to local centre at Tavy Bridge

Linear housing block in Area II



AREA II

AREA II layout plan



ANALYSIS

Gross Area	50.8 hectares	(127 acres)
Housing Area		
GLC site	16.4 hectares	(41 acres)
Private	3.2 hectares	(7.9 acres)
Population		
GLC	4244 people in 1251 dwellings	
Private	800 people in 150 dwellings	
Density		
GLC	255 persons per hectare	(102 pp acre)
Private	170 persons per hectare	(68 pp acre)
Car Parking	1 space per dwelling	

Storeys	Persons/dwellings							Totals	
	OPD I	II	II	III	IV	V	VI	Dwellings	Persons
13			216	216				432	1080
5		195		9	88	85		182	804
4		195						195	390
3					279	122	41	442	1963
		195	216	225	367	207	41	1251	4244

HOUSING TYPES

All the housing in this area is constructed with components from the Industrialised Building Factory.

The layout and design of the local authority sector of Area II are based on the same general planning principles, housing block and type plans and industrialised constructional methods as Area I but financial restraints, which resulted from the introduction of the then Ministry of Housing Cost Yardstick for local authority housing in 1969, made it necessary for economies to be exercised in the general form of buildings and their services.

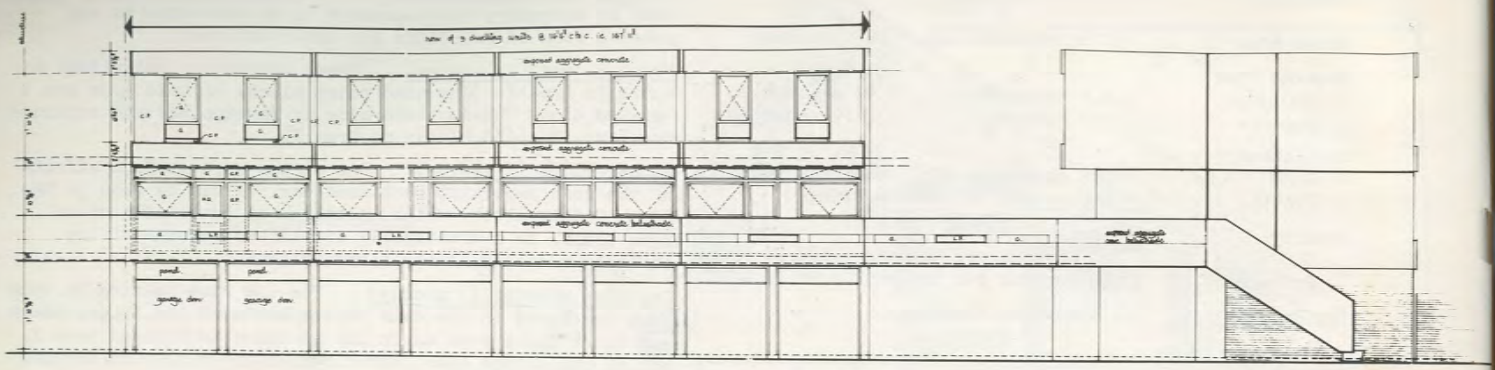
Point Blocks (13 storey) These blocks are indentical to those in Area I. The nine point blocks in this area are located along the southern side of Yarnton Way and continue the line of point blocks in Area I.

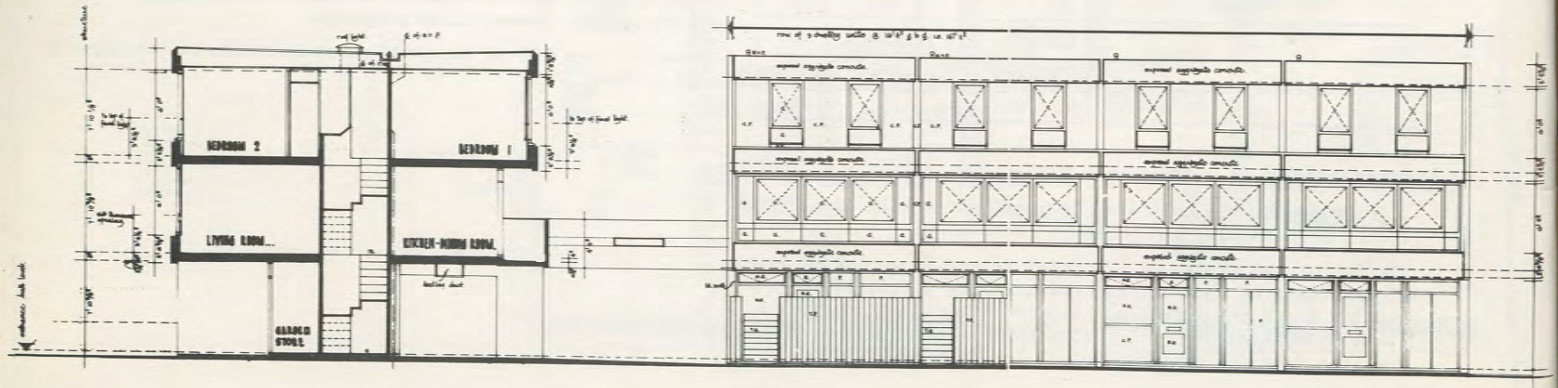
Linear Block (5 storey) One of the more obvious effects of the cost restraint mentioned earlier can be seen in the form of this block, which, although it contains similar type plans, is a drastically simplified version of the strongly modelled linear block in Area I.

Low Rise Housing (3 storey) The low rise housing in this Area is placed in the same relationship to the linear block and point block zone as in the southern section of Area I, but it has a more open layout, providing larger landscaped squares in place of the more intimate courtyards of Area I.

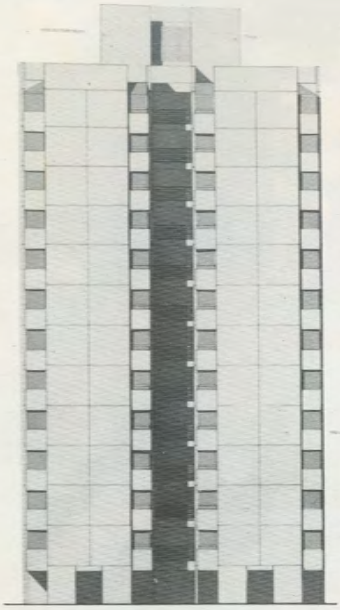
Old Peoples Dwellings (5 storey) Flats for the old people in Area II are provided in three blocks situated between the linear block and the family housing zone. Each block is served by lifts and is closely related to the footpath network and the linear block walkways.

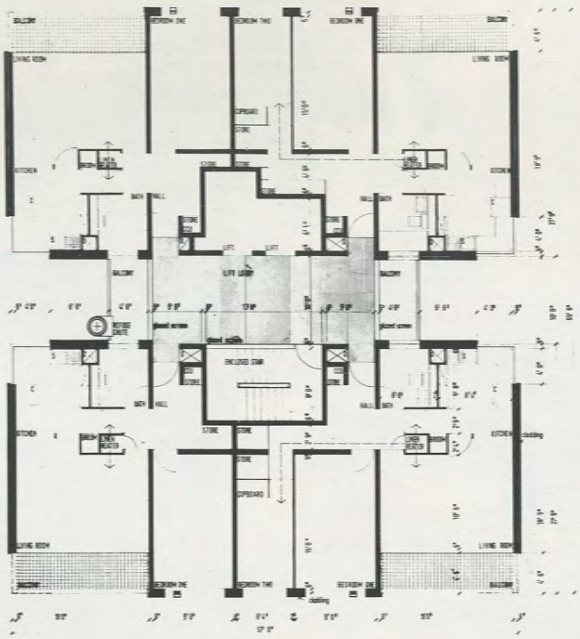
Old people form 10% of the population in this Area as opposed to 3% in Area I.

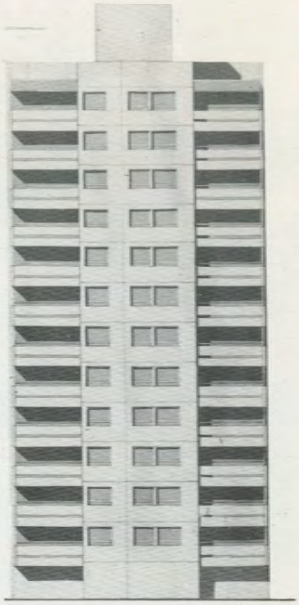




ELEVATIONS AND SECTION OF LOW RISE HOUSING IN AREA II







Point Blocks
Typical plan (centre) north and south elevations (left)
East and west elevations (right)



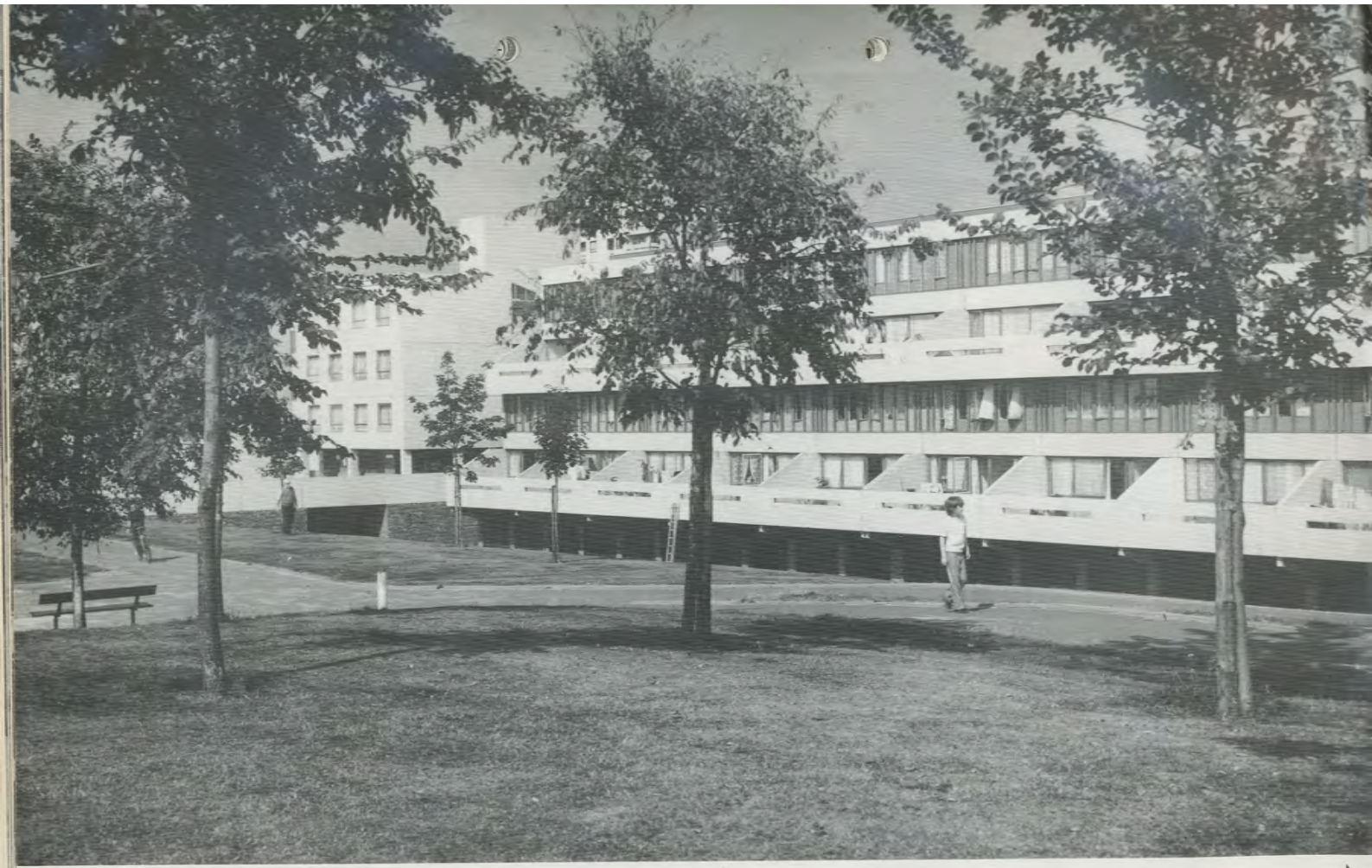


Linear block (left) and low rise housing (right) in Area II

Typical point block

Elderly persons housing and courtyard in Area II





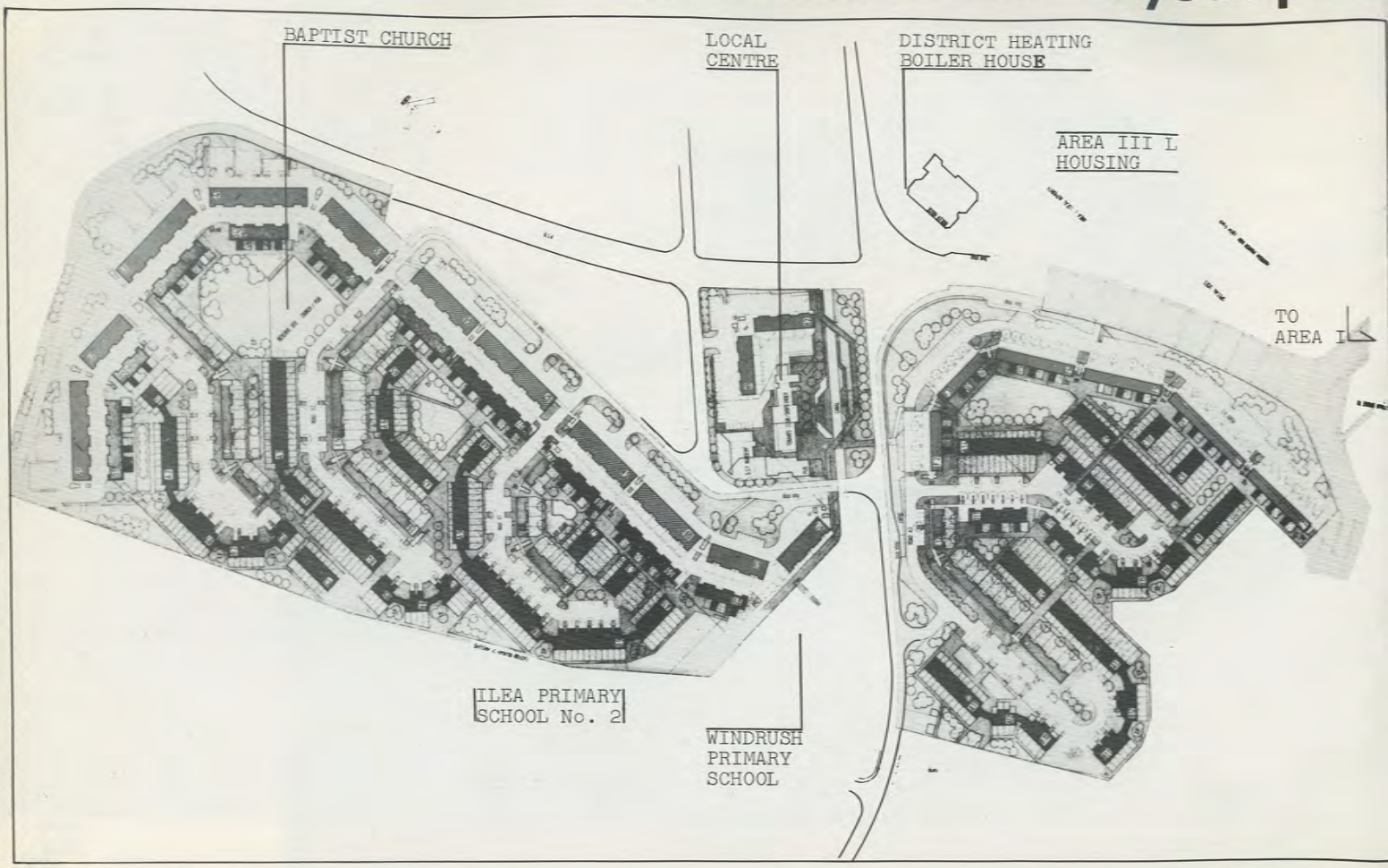
Linear housing block in Area II
elevation to open space link

Linear housing block in Area IIIA



AREAS IIIA & D

AREA IIIA & D layout plan



ANALYSIS

Gross Area	16.12 hectares	(41.5 acres)
Housing Area	15.92 hectares	(39.3 acres)
Population	5217 people in 1418 dwellings	
Density	287 persons per hectare (116 pp acre)	
Car Parking	1 space per dwelling	

Storeys	Persons/dwellings						Totals	
	OPD I	II	II	IV	V	VI	Dwellings	Persons
2 D Block		80			37		117	345
3 ABC Blks					266	80	346	1810
4 E Blocks				161			161	644
5 F Blocks	9			92	17		118	462
5-8 H Blocks		36	36				72	144
5-9 G Blocks		180	122	302			604	1812
	9	296	159	555	320	80	1418	5217

HOUSING TYPES

Due to financial restraints of the housing cost yardstick imposed by the Department of the Environment, every effort has been made to reduce cost by further standardisation and simplification of layout and building form.

Linear Blocks (Balency System) 722 dwellings

5 storey (F Blocks) There are seven of these blocks comprising a total of 118 dwellings in Area IIIA. Each Block contains 5 person patio flats and a small number of 1 person flats at ground level with garages facing the major road. Over the garages at first floor level is a wide pedestrian deck which links up with a footbridge over the spine road connecting Area III with the linear block in Area I. On the floors above are 92 four person maisonettes with access from the first floor deck and a walkway at third floor level.

5-9 Storey (G Blocks) These blocks are situated in Area IIID and contain 302 two person and 302 four person flats, with garages at ground floor level. Walkways are continuous from block to block and provide covered access from the north of the area to the south adjacent to the Local Centre.

Where the linear blocks are fulfilling their function as noise shields, living accommodation is located on the far side away from the road. However, in certain cases the road side offers exceptional views of the river and in order to exploit this situation, sound proofing and ventilating techniques have been employed in certain living rooms.

Rationalised Traditional Blocks - 696 dwellings

5-8 Storeys (H Blocks) These blocks are located in the Local Centre and contain 72 two person flats with garages at ground floor level. The blocks share a common access stair and two lifts are linked to the residents' clubroom by a pedestrian deck at first floor level.

4 storeys (E Blocks) These blocks, distributed throughout Areas IIIA and D are made up entirely of 4 person maisonettes, the lower having gardens and access at ground level. Staircase access is provided to upper maisonettes and each has a private balcony.

2 Storeys (D Blocks) These blocks have 5 person patio flats and garages at ground floor level, with 2 person flats served by way of a deck over the garages.

3 Storeys (A Blocks) Each block contains 5 person family houses with gardens.

3 Storeys (B Blocks) Each block contains 5 person family houses similar to the A blocks but with integral garages.

3 Storey (C Blocks) Each block contains 6 person family houses.

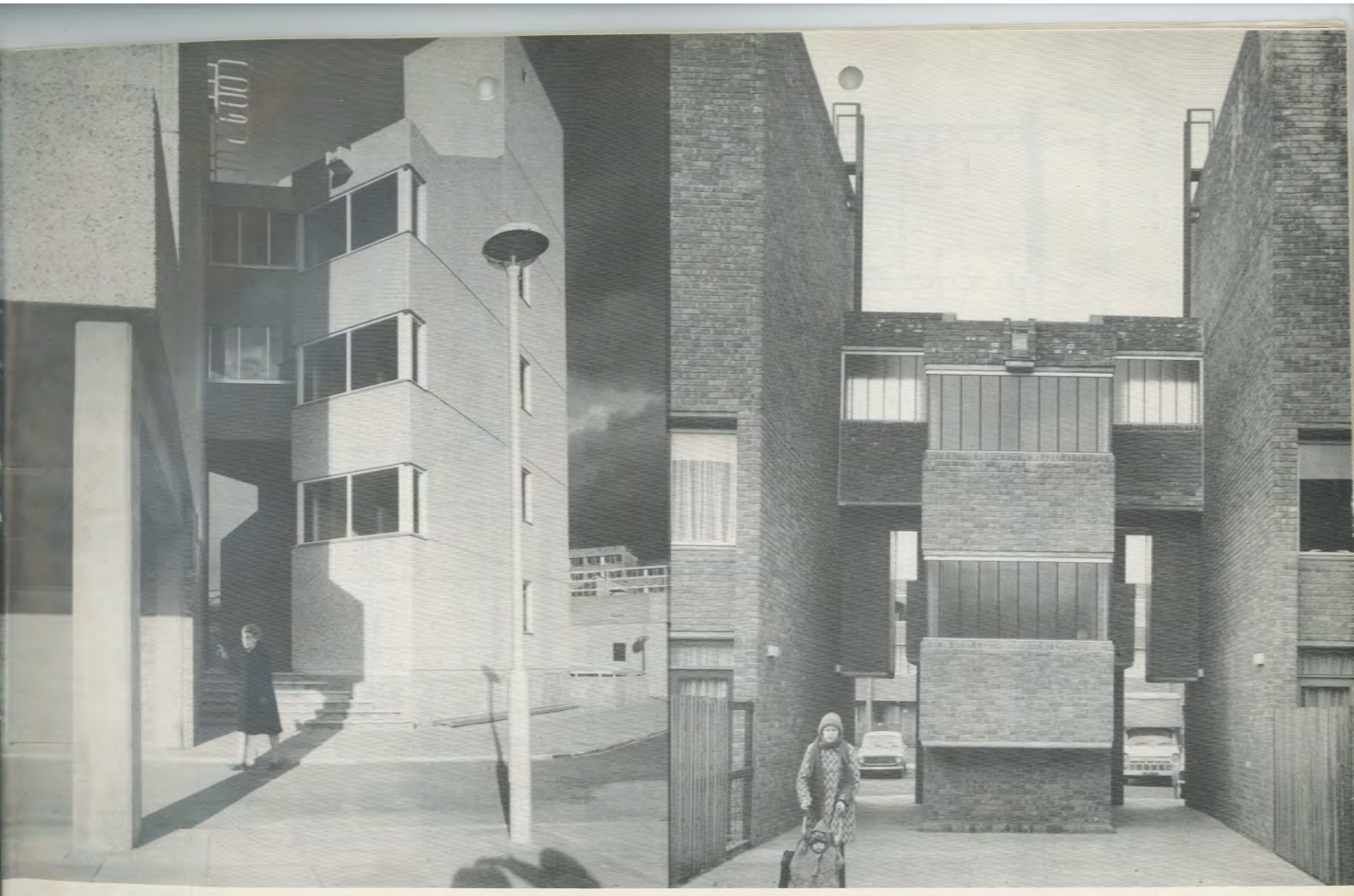
Old Peoples Dwellings Accommodation for old people has been located in a number of blocks:

In Area IIIA: The first floor of the D Blocks (12 dwellings).

In Area IIID: The upper floor of the two storey D Blocks (68 dwellings).
The second and third floors of the G Blocks (180 dwellings).
The first, second and third floors of both H Blocks in the Local Centre (36 dwellings).

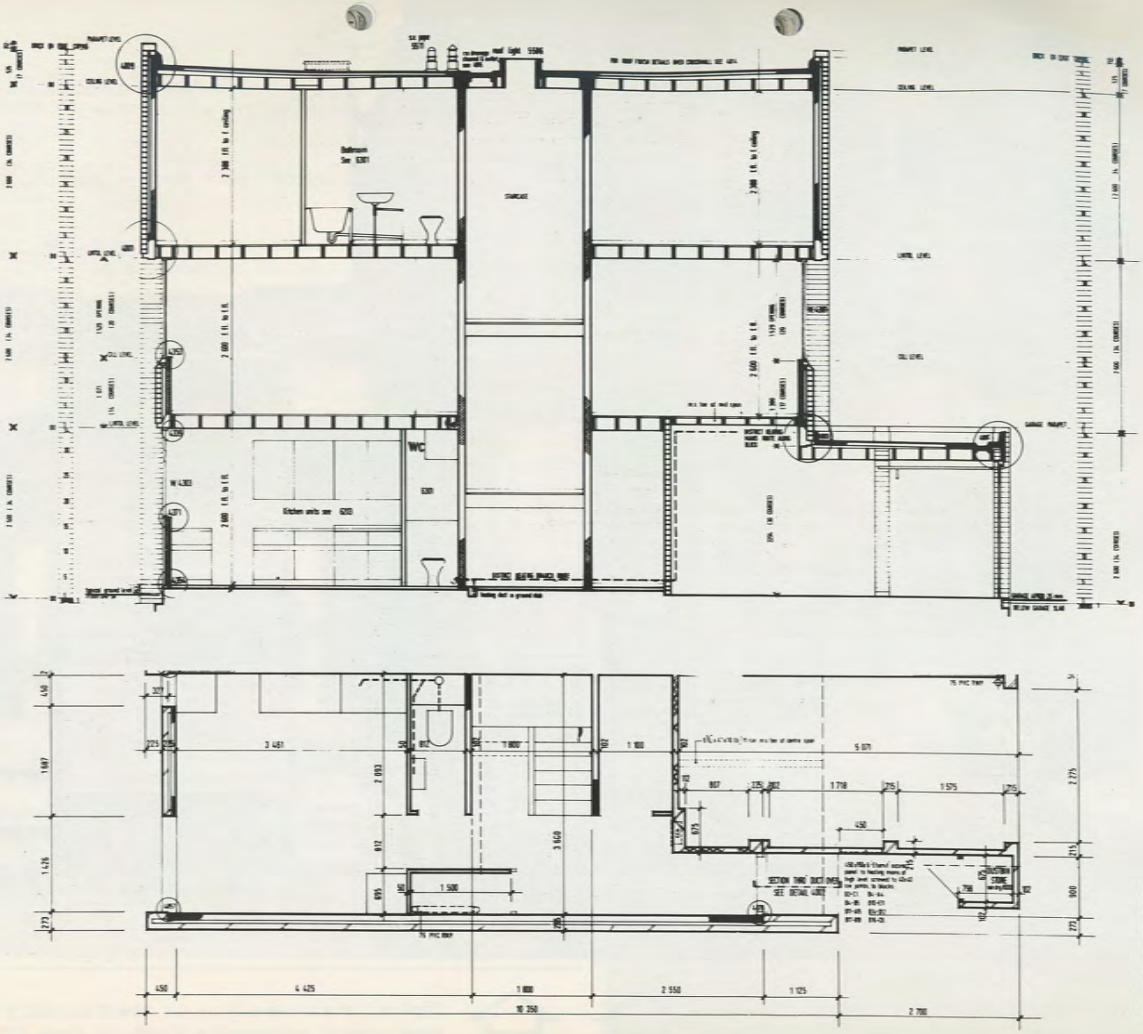


Traditionally built low rise housing in Area IIIA

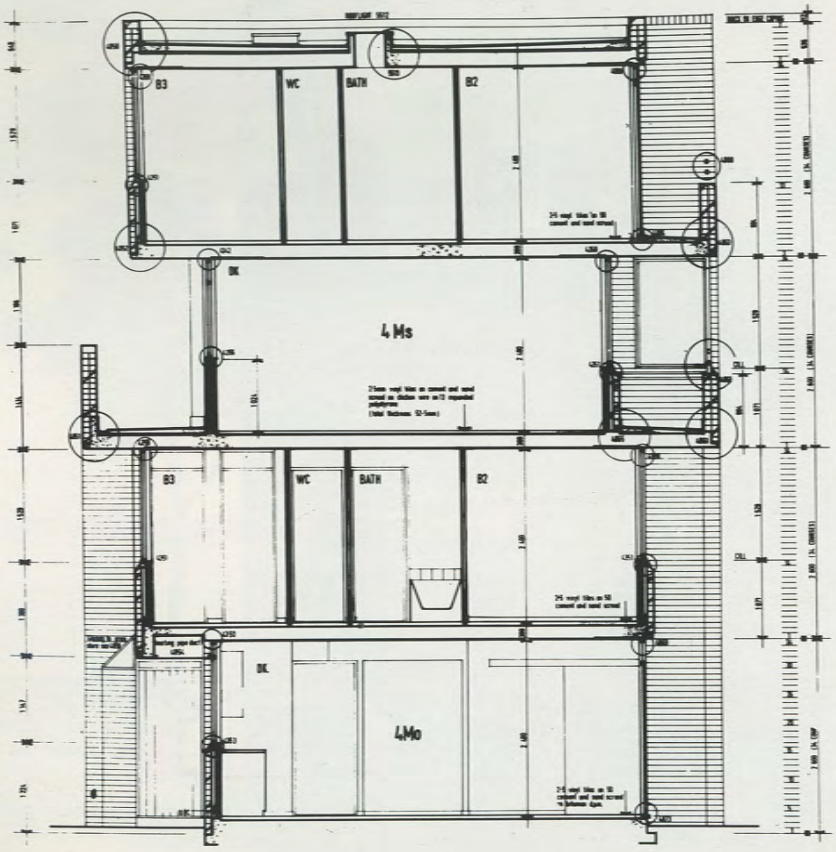


Typical staircase link in the industrialised linear block, Area III

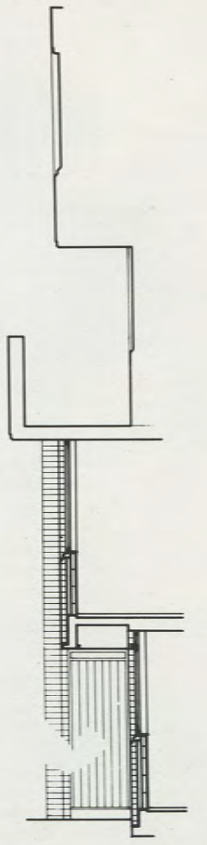
Typical staircase link in traditionally constructed maisonette block in Area III



Section and plan of typical low rise house with garage in Area III



Typical section through traditionally constructed maisonette block in Area III



ALTERNATIVE SECTION TO BLOCKS



Childrens play area on the raised open space between Areas I and II

View across Southmere Lake to point blocks and low rise housing in Area I





OPEN SPACE AND WATER

In addition to the amenity open spaces immediately associated with the housing and containing a number of small play areas for toddlers and juniors, a public open space link has been created between Areas I and II joining the woodland of Lesnes Abbey with the first stages of the development, the lake and the whole future system of public open spaces throughout Thamesmead and ultimately to the riverside walks. The linear block in Area II defines the eastern edge of this 60 metre (200 feet) wide elevated strip of landscaped open space which separates the two areas. This strip helps to introduce substantial modelling to an otherwise flat landscape and was formed of the excavated material from the lake in Area I.

This lake, Southmere, has a water area of 10 hectares (25 acres) and is Thamesmead's first lake. Its recreational potential is obvious and it is very extensively used, but it is also an important element in the Thamesmead system of land drainage, storing the surface water collected from Area I and the hinterland to the south so that it can be discharged through the canals into the Thames.

One of the first sections of the Thamesmead canal network crosses the site between Areas IIIA and IIID. Together with the associated footpaths and cycle track it has been designed as an integral element in the layout of the area.

Area I Local Centre

Section of canal from Southmere Lake, with point blocks of Area I in background


POLICE
LAKESID
3

LOCAL SHOPPING AND COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Although Area I is adjoining established housing areas with their shopping and community facilities, it was considered essential to the early success of the scheme that facilities were also available within the development. A Local Centre in Area I, at Tavy Bridge contains 10 shops, a bank, a police office, and a rent office as well as a wide range of community facilities. The provisions include a Residents Clubroom, a Medical Centre and a Branch Library (all located in association with the local shopping centre). Nearby a Childrens Water Recreation Area has been incorporated in a shallow extension of the lake and a large car park provided at ground level under the centre.

Other facilities in Area I are:

A Public House (The Barge Pole) sited below the linear block in the southern section of the Area on one of the main footpaths to the bus stops in Harrow Manor Way.
A Community Centre used for a wide range of community activities.
An Ecumenical Centre (Church of the Holy Cross) located on adjoining sites on the south east corner of the Area, close to the Area II housing.
A Lakeside Complex with boat storage arrangements adjacent to Southmere, on the site of the temporary boiler house at the northern end of the linear block.
Play Areas for younger children are incorporated in the court yards associated with low rise housing, while playgrounds, kick about areas and a supervised one o'clock club have been provided in areas of open space further away from the housing, in Area II.

Although residents have access to the shopping centre in Area I, a smaller local centre in Area II contains a supermarket, a Post Office, and a two storey building housing a Residents' and Old Peoples Clubroom. A site for a Public House has also been reserved in the local centre.

A complex of halls has been built on the northern side of Yarnton Way by the Baptist Church which provides a range of services to the community.

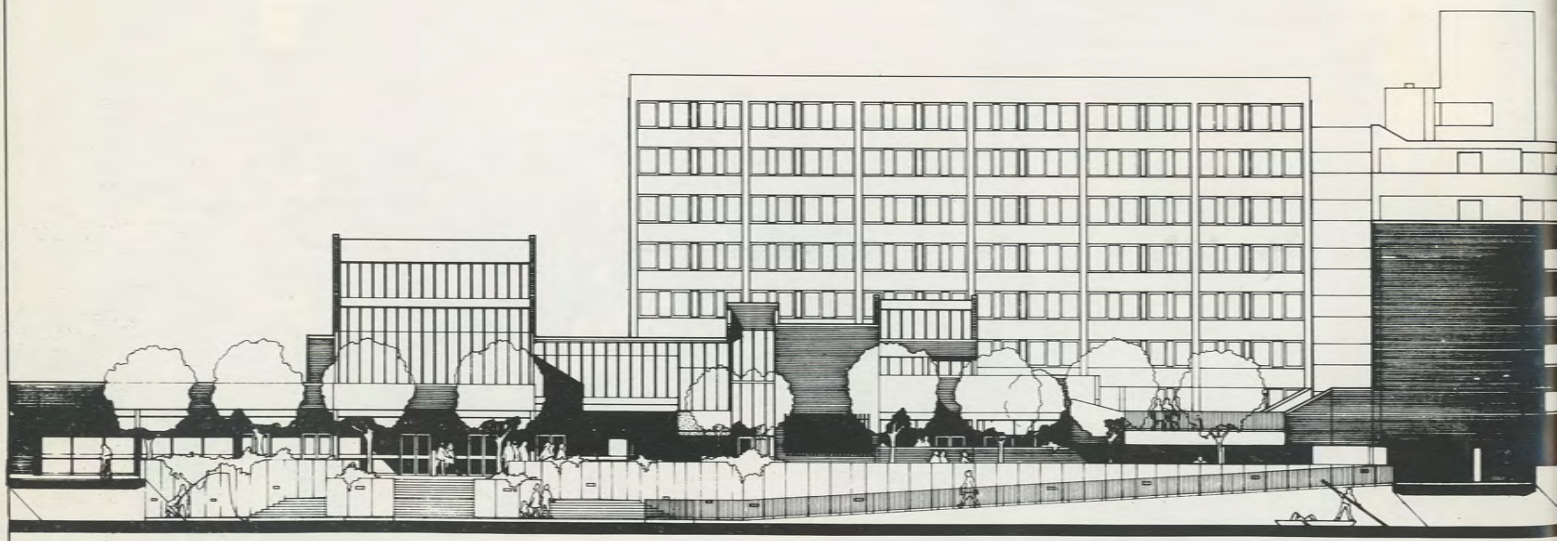
The local centre in Area III houses six shop units but it is anticipated that three of these will be combined to form a small supermarket. Adjacent to the shops is a 2 storey building housing an old peoples clubroom at ground level and a tenants clubroom on the first floor. A site has been reserved for a public house and there is also to be a nursery/playroom. There will also be a Baptist Church in this area.



Childrens water recreation area and medical centre in Area I

Local Centre in Area II


BUS STOP



South East elevation of the Local Centre in Area III

EDUCATIONAL FACILITIES

The responsibility for education at Thamesmead is shared between the London Borough of Bexley, which is responsible for education provision within Bexley, and the Inner London Education Authority, for the area lying within Greenwich. The London Borough of Bexley is responsible for education in that part of Thamesmead development which lies to the east of a line running northwards from Harrow Manor Way and includes Areas I and II.

Working in conjunction with the Greater London Council as both the development authority and the housing authority for Thamesmead, the Bexley Education Authority has prepared a development plan for the provision of schools to serve each area. The primary schools are distributed as follows:

Area I	1 school of 280 places + nursery 1 school of 560 places
Area II	1 school of 560 places 1 school (voluntary aided) of 280 places

School building projects require the approval of the Department of Education and Science and the Authority submits a bid for each project to be built and completed coincident with the estimated completion date of the housing developments in each area. Abbey Primary School and Southlake Primary School in Area I were opened in 1969 and 1970 respectively. In Area II St. John Fisher, a Roman Catholic School, was opened early in 1969 to be followed in September of that year by the first phase of the permanent building of Parkway Primary School.

It is estimated that the total secondary school provision required for the five Bexley areas will amount to 12 forms of entry. As a first stage an instalment of Riverside School in Area II was opened in September 1972 to provide five forms of entry. The school also serves as a centre for non-vocational evening classes for adults.

The Thamesmead Youth Centre was opened in 1972. It shares the site and part of the accommodation of the secondary school and includes facilities for non-vocational classes and informal activities for young people.

No special provision for full-time further education is planned as facilities are available at the nearby Erith College of Technology.

Area III is situated in the London Borough of Greenwich and education in this borough is the responsibility of the Inner London Education Authority. Windrush School, a one form entry primary school, is located immediately to the west of the Local Centre and a two form entry primary school (No. 2) to the west of Area IIID have been provided by the ILEA. A Youth Club adjacent to the Primary School No. 2 and a secondary school (Waterfield) to serve Areas III and IV are also being constructed. Families in Area III will also have access to the St. Margaret Clitheroe Roman Catholic Primary School which is situated in Area IIIB and to ILEA Primary School No. 6 (under construction) located in Area IV, north of Area IIID.

PRIVATE HOUSING DEVELOPMENT

Area I

A site of 3.1 hectares (7.8 acres) of private sector housing is situated off Alsike Road on the western side of the open space link. The site was handed over to the developers in May 1972 and 132 dwellings have been built by Bovis New Homes (London) Ltd.

Area II

A further site of 3.2 hectares (8 acres) for private sector housing was handed over to Contemporary Homes Ltd. in December 1971. 150 dwellings are planned on this site which is situated north of Yarnton Way and bounded on the east by the open space link.

Thamesmead has been designed by the Greater London Council Department of Architecture and Civic Design, Architect to the Council and Controller of Construction Services, Sir Roger Walters, KBE, FRIBA, FIStructE (in succession to Sir Hubert Bennett).

The following officers have been responsible:

Housing and ancillary facilities
Special Works Architect and Thamesmead Manager, Geoffrey Horsfall

Divisional Architect, Thamesmead Division
Eric Hayes
(in succession to J G H D Cairns)

Schools and Educational Facilities for the Inner London Education Authority
Education Architect, Peter E Jones

Civil Engineering Works
The Housing Engineer, R P Manning-Coe

Officers from other GLC departments who have also been responsible are:

The Chief Officer of the Parks Department, J C Kennedy
The Director of Mechanical and Electrical Engineering, P C Hoare
The Controller of Planning and Transportation, F B Pooley
The Valuer and Estates Surveyor, K M Blessley
The Controller of Housing, H G Simpson

FURTHER INFORMATION

A detailed bibliography (Research Bibliography No. 62 June 1975) has been compiled by the GLC Research Library and is available from the GLC Bookshop, The County Hall, London SE1 7PB, price 40 pence.

Other brochures in this series are available from the address below

Thamesmead - An Introduction
Thamesmead - Future Developments

All enquiries about the work of the GLC Department of Architecture and Civic Design should be addressed to:

The Information Officer
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